# Law & Tech Entrepreneurs

Welcome, future law & tech entrepreneurs! In this course, you'll learn about how law & tech interact, create legal tech, and pitch your ideas to an expert audience.

## For whom is this course?

This course is targeted at Bachelor students in Computer Science, Law, Law & Economics, or Business Administration. There are no prerequisites for this course. However, success in this course relies on a willingness to actively engage during the sessions, with the instructors, and with your colleagues. A collaborative attitude and openness to discussing the legal and societal dimensions of the increased development and deployment of technology, specifically in the legal domain, will significantly enrich the learning experience.

**TL;DR:** Come motivated to learn, create, and present your ideas!

## When does this course take place?

This course will take place over **3 days**: the first day, October 10, 2026, will be an introductory day to prepare you for the legal hackathon on November 7-8.

## What is this course about?

Both law and computation have been permeating our private and professional lives: The law has done so for thousands of years already by determining the social and economic structures in which we interact, while, in comparison, digitalization has only been transforming our societal fabric. Understanding how the law can enable or constrain innovation within the broad domain of computation or digitalization is central for *developers and engineers* to determine how to shape future, responsible computing as well as regulatory environments. At the same time, the very same technological advancements that policymakers are trying to regulate are changing the very nature of law. Legal tech, legal engineers, and legal AI are now common terms that dominate the discourse for legal innovation and are commonly used in legal practice. This means that *legal practitioners and students* need a better understanding of how technology is changing their very field. In this course, we look at these interactions between law and technology and take a hands-on approach by collaboratively working on legal technologies.

## Learning objectives

This is an interdisciplinary course that integrates students in Computer Science, Law, Law & Economics, and Business Administration. This course aims not only to foster your

interdisciplinary skill set but, depending on your disciplinary background, also to elevate your critical thinking competencies within this field.

- **For students with a background in Law and Law & Economics:** Critically evaluate the technical and ethical feasibility of automating specific legal processes and the resulting impact on due process.
- **For students with a background in Computer Science:** Understand key technology law concepts and how those can be translated into functional system requirements and evaluate those approaches (in terms os responsibility).
- **For students with a Business Administration background:** Identify and leverage innovative potential of law & tech to create value and optimize compliance.
- **For everyone, the overarching objectives of the course are:**
    - Describe practicable, future-facing solutions that enable a symbiotic relationship between automation/AI, law, and society
    - Analyze complex issues at the intersection of technology and law, which necessitates the integration of several viewpoints/methods/fields

In addition, you will acquire transversal skills by:

- Demonstrating a capacity for creativity.
- Working on a concrete project and writing a technical report.
- Setting objectives and designing an action plan to reach those objectives.
- Demonstrating the capacity for critical thinking
- Evaluating your own performance in the team, receiving and responding appropriately to feedback.

## Program and important dates/tasks

| Date | Content |
|---|---|
| 10/Oct | **Introduction:** At the beginning of the session, we will introduce the overall idea of the course: understanding the relationship between law and technology not only as a question of regulation, but also as a field of innovation. When thinking about “Law & Technology,” one might first think of legal rules that govern data processing, cybersecurity, platforms, automation, or artificial intelligence. However, the relationship between law and technology goes in both directions. Law shapes the design, deployment, and limits of technological systems, while technology increasingly changes how legal services are delivered, how legal processes are organized, and how legal problems are identified and solved. Within this first day, we will discuss key examples of legal tech, automation, AI, regulation, and innovation, and you will learn how legal problems can be translated into practical project ideas. You will also receive an overview of the course requirements, the mandatory readings, the group work, and the legal hackathon on November 7–8. By the end of the day, you will be prepared to form interdisciplinary teams and start developing your own Law & Tech project.<br><br>**Note**: Depending on the disciplinary background registered for the course, we will have different modules for students with a technical background and those without. Please come to class prepared (see mandatory task) to get the most out of this day and be as well prepared as possible for the legal hackathon in November.<br><br>**Mandatory tasks prior to the course:** Get a copy of the mandatory reading and establish your own timeline to read those books prior to the hackathon. |

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| 31/Oct | **Formation of groups:** Please register for the legal hackathon on the website and form the groups on Canvas by October 31 (23:59). Make sure you follow the instructions given in class and register both on the website and on Canvas.<br><br>Note: Hackathons are a collaborative effort and you are expected to work on the project as part of a team; therefore, no individual presentations will be allowed. The topics and titles of the projects can be amended until **7/Nov**. Follow the instructions provided during the legal hackathon. |
| 7+8/Nov | **Legal Hackathon:** A legal hackathon is a hands-on, collaborative event in which interdisciplinary teams develop practical solutions to legal or law-related problems within a limited period of time. Participants work together to identify a problem, develop an idea, build or design a prototype, and present their solution to an audience or jury. In a legal hackathon, the focus is not only on coding. While technical development can be an important part of the project, legal hackathons also involve legal reasoning, problem analysis, user-centered design, policy thinking, business modeling, and communication. A team might, for example, create a digital tool that helps people understand their legal rights, design a system that supports compliance with regulation, develop an AI-assisted legal workflow, build a prototype for access to justice, or create a concept for improving transparency in automated decision-making. The "legal" dimension means that the project should address a legal problem, a legal process, a regulatory challenge, or the broader relationship between law, technology, and society. The "hackathon" dimension means that participants work on challenges that are provided by the sponsors creatively and intensively under time pressure, often moving quickly from problem definition to solution design and presentation. The challenges will be distributed only shortly before on this website: https://www.legalhackathons.org/<br><br>Submission of the legal and technical documentation (follow the instructions at the hackathon): On **8/Nov** you will be required to upload the legal and technical documentation of your hackathon project both to Canvas (for this course) and send it to the legal hackathon organizers. |
| 10/Nov | **Submission of pitches as videos:** upload to Canvas. |
| 22/Nov | **Submission of individual reflection:** upload to Canvas. |

## Mandatory reading

**For students with a technical background:** Mayer-Schönberger, V., & Ramge, T. (2022). Access Rules: Freeing Data from Big Tech for a Better Future. Univ of California Press.

**For students with a non-technical background:** Tamò-Larrieux, A., Guitton, C., & Mayer, S. (2025). AI and law: how automation is changing the law. Chapman and Hall/CRC.

## Evaluation modalities and criteria

### *Group project during the legal hackathon in groups of up to 4 students from your class (70%)*

***Submission of legal and technical documentation and short report (40%)***

The technical documentation presents the legal problem addressed by the team, the proposed solution, and the design and implementation of the prototype. It should enable

others to understand how the project works, evaluate the integration of legal and technical considerations, and reproduce or test the main features.

The evaluation criteria will include:

- ☐ **Functionality and prototype quality**: The prototype should demonstrate the core idea of the project and show that the proposed solution can work in practice.
- ☐ **Technical design and architecture**: The technical structure should be understandable, appropriate for the project goal, and based on deliberate design choices.
- ☐ **Legal and technical integration**: The technical solution should clearly respond to the legal or law-related problem identified by the team.
- ☐ **Responsible and ethical technology design:** The project should show awareness of risks such as privacy, security, fairness, transparency, accountability, and the limits of automation.
- ☐ **Documentation and reproducibility:** The submission should include clear instructions explaining how the prototype works, how it can be tested, and what dependencies or tools were used.
- ☐ **Team contribution and transparency:** The submission should clearly state each team member's contribution and disclose the use of AI tools, open-source components, or external resources.

***Submission of pitch (in the form of a up to 3-minute-long video) (30%)***
The pitch presents the project's problem, relevance, proposed solution, and expected impact in a clear and convincing manner. Teams should demonstrate how their prototype works and communicate the value of their project effectively within the given time limit.

To record the video, we suggest you activate the recording function on a Zoom conference call while sharing your screen with the pitch presentation. Within your pitches, you should address at least these different points:

- ☐ What is your group project about?
- ☐ Why is it relevant?
- ☐ How does it work?
- ☐ What goals are you pursuing, and how will this impact the field?

The **evaluation criteria** will be divided into two aspects: (1) related to the content of the pitch/presentation, and (2) related to the formalities. Regarding **content**, we will evaluate how convincingly you pitch the project and address the points above. Regarding **formalities**, we will evaluate how well structured the short presentation is and how convincingly you address the points.

## *Individual reflection paper (30%)*

As this is an interdisciplinary course and you are assigned different readings depending on your disciplinary background, your reflection pieces will take only part of the literature into account. In other words, this reflection piece is designed to be the "bridge" between the

theoretical concepts in your mandatory readings and the high-intensity, practical experience of the hackathon. Since you are reading different books based on your background, this assignment asks you to act as an "ambassador" for your discipline, explaining how your new knowledge influences your view of the Law & Tech landscape.

**Modalities**: Your reflection piece should not be longer than 800 words (roughly 2-3 pages). It should include a statement of your initial perspective on the interaction of law and technology and how this perspective changed throughout the course (if at all). Weave in some of the main points in the mandatory reading that stuck with you and reflect on your group project and how it contributed to your knowledge in the field of computational law.

**Evaluation criteria:** We will evaluate how well you articulate and critically reflect on the course' content and work. We will positively take into account reflection pieces that integrate well with the mandatory reading and even go beyond it by incorporating additional readings or connections to real-world events. Your reflection pieces should follow a clear, easy-to-follow structure (e.g., organize them around main themes).

**Important**: If you miss any group deadlines or do not submit the individual assignment, we will grade the evaluation component as a zero (0).

## Rules of conduct during the course

We are committed to creating a learning environment in which we can share our questions, perspectives, and thoughts in an atmosphere of mutual respect and trust. To this end, we ask everyone to strive to adhere to the following principles:

- First and foremost, please treat other participants in this course with respect.
- Avoid ad hominem attacks. It is perfectly legitimate to criticize a point of view expressed by another participant, but it is inappropriate to criticize the person expressing a point of view.
- When engaged in a discussion, strive to best interpret the position taken by the other person.
- Listen carefully to people who have expertise or experience relevant to the topic under discussion, but keep a critical mind.
- Finally, remember that everyone makes missteps and mistakes.

If the rules of conduct are not being followed, please do not hesitate to contact the teaching assistants. Thank you! We look forward to working with you all and learning from you.

## Rules on AI

### AI and role assignment

For all assignments (presentations, pitches, documentation, reports), you must submit and present original, self-created work. To ensure academic standards are met, each submission must include a "Statement of Author Contribution and AI Use" based on the following principles:

**Accountability:**

- ☐ You and all members of the group are collectively responsible for all work submitted. Everyone must be able to explain all parts of the project, including those for which AI tools were used.

**Transparency**:

- ☐ The AI use statement must explicitly state the AI tools used, their purpose (e.g., generating initial ideas, improving text clarity, searching for references, summarizing arguments), and specify each use.

**Integrity**:

- ☐ The use of AI must comply with academic integrity rules (see SNSF, European Code of Conduct for Research Integrity).

## Contact details

We encourage you to ask questions during the lectures. If you have any questions after the lectures, you can visit our offices or contact us by email or on the forum:

- Course coordinator: Aurelia Tamò-Larrieux, aurelia.tamo@unisg.ch
- Course tutor: dick.blankvoort@student.unisg.ch

This syllabus is a plan, and like any plan, it is subject to change. 🙂 Therefore, it is possible that I will make (smaller) adjustments throughout the semester, based on your interests and goals. I very much look forward to this course and your participation. I hope it will be helpful to you in several ways as you move forward in your career.